RogaineSCORE updates from version 2.1.0 to 3.0.0

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1 INTRODUCTION.

There has been a sequence of releases between 2.1.0 and this one. Some of them provided sanity checks and warning messages, but unfortunately this also introduced some bugs. Other releases transferred the printing to another thread, with the aim of speeding up the printing. This also had some issues, depending on the printer used. A rolling results display was deployed at WRC 2016, but issues with massive network loading occurred.

Other developments included a method for combining and separating punches and tags from multiple sets of equipment, to cater for large events.

This release resolves the known issues, and introduces some new features.

- For the first time, score printing starts when the Reader light flashes Green rather than when you remove the Tag.
- Networking has been simplified to reduce traffic and increase speed.
- Support is provided for legacy Serial-port readers.
- Tags from duration-limited courses can be read mid-course to determine the time still available.
- Tag printouts show the causes of discrepancies within a team.
- Scored tags can be edited to insert or delete punches. This is critical for missed FINISH or DEPART Punches for example.
- Rawtag files can be created and modified for lost Tags
- Tags assigned to Course "SETTER" will read and display Punch IDs and punch times.
- There are some other minor improvements to the UI.

2 NEW TOOLS.

2.1 Combining and separating Tags and Punches from different sets.

For large or significant events you may want to add extra tags, or use multiple punches at each checkpoint for reliability. Afterwards you will need to sort them back into their original sets.

2.1.1 Combining Tag and Punch sets.

Before you combine different sets of tags and punches, ensure that you have saved all the original Tagnums.txt and Punchnums.txt files. Since they have the same name you must save them in different folders, presumably named after the providers of the sets.

The safest way to combine the tagnums files is to create a new one. Remove tagnums.txt from your event folder, then erase all the new tags. That automatically adds them to a new tagnums.txt file and ensures they are all erased.

To combine punches, you can manually edit one of the files by copying the contents of the other files into it. Be careful with formatting – no leading spaces, and no blank lines.

The ERASE TAGS window has help and tools for combining Tagnums.txt files, and the EVENT SETUP – Punch Values – Function method has help and tools for combining Punchnums files.

2.1.2 Separating Tags and Punches into original sets.

Restoring your Punchnums.txt file can be done the same way you may have combined them, from the Event Setup –Punch Values –FUNCTION... OTHER Punch sets menu. Alternatively you can just replace your Punchnums.txt file from a saved version of the original.

The Tagnums.txt file should be replaced with a saved version of the original.

To physically separate the tags and punches into their original sets, support is provided from the TOOLS... TOOLS HELP Menu in both PROGRAM PUNCHES and ERASE TAGS windows.

These tools show a colour corresponding to the set which the Tag or Punch came from, when you read it. For this to work, you must have previously saved the original Tagnums.txt and Punchnums.txt files in other folders.

2.2 The SEARCH tool.

A 'SEARCH' tool is added to the READTAGS Tools... Menu. It allows you to search for a competitor or team by name. You enter a name or part name, and all matching entries from Tagnums.txt are displayed. The search narrows as you enter more detail.

The display shows all team members, a team name, their team number and category, and if they have finished it shows their score and finish time.

You can also show scored results for each tag in a given team.

You can also find which people visited a given punch (extracted from Tag records).

SEARCH for punches shows records from all punches with the same Punch number. GROUP punches are included.

2.3 Printing the Display and Help windows.

The HELP... and Score Windows can be printed, either to the default printer or to a file. They have a menu item for this.

3 NETWORKING.

Networking provides faster scoring capability by using more than one computer, and also provides backup.

3.1 Network setup guide.

You should choose ONE computer only as the source for Event files. These files are Tagnums.txt, Punchnums.txt, and TagReader_Options.txt. Let’s call this computer “Me”. Then you have a second computer which we will call “Backup.

The Readtags.. Network... menu allows you to choose network folders. There are two lists of computers for you to fill in. The top list is the computer which you will read source files from, and the bottom list is the computers you will write to.

- On the “Me” computer, put “Me” in the top box, and find the path to the “Backup” computer in the bottom box. Validate and Save.

- On the “Backup” computer, find the path to the “Me” computer in the top box, and put the same path in the bottom box. Validate and Save, then SYNCHRONISE from the Network menu.
- For all additional computers, find the path to the “Me” computer in the top box, and the paths to the “Me” and “Backup” computers in the bottom box. Validate, Save, and SYNCHRONISE.
- If a ‘Rolling Results” computer is being used, all computers must write to it. Therefore the Rolling Results computer could well be used as the “Backup” computer.

All synched computers will hold copies of all the source files, and any scored files at the time of synching. Thus any computer can be the ‘Master” after it has been synched.

See 'NETWORK... HELP...' from the READTAGS menu for more information.

3.2 Which writes to What.

Whenever a computer scores a Tag, the Rawtag and ScoredTag files are written to all computers in the bottom box. Therefore the “Me” and “Backup” computers are always up to date. However any extra computers will only contain files which have been scored on that computer.

Any computer can be completely up-dated at any time by using “SYNCHRONISE”. This copies newer files from all computers which can write to your computer, not just the ones in the top box. This means that the “Me” and “Backup” computers will update from all networked computers, while the other computers will only update from the “Me” and “Backup” computers.

NOTE: Summary files cannot be copied. Therefore before RESULTS are printed, the results computer must “Re-score ALL”.

3.3 How links are managed.

Changes have been made to the way networked computers register their presence on the net. This is to avoid delays if one disconnects and others try writing to it. This is important if there are more than two computers networked.

Whenever you synchronise to the network, your computer tries to write a file to each computer whose Path is stored in your file ‘Network_Options.txt’. This file is created when you choose Network folders and SAVE them.
If the write is successful, a file “__<computername>.txt” is written to your event folder, and a file “__<your computer name> is written to the networked computer event folder. You will then have two or three files starting with “__” in your folder.

When a Tag is scored, the files are written to each computer which has its “__” file in your folder. If the write fails, the appropriate “__” file in your folder is deleted. This inhibits further attempts to write to that computer.

If the disconnected computer connects again, when it synchronises, the “__” file will again be written to your computer, so future scoring will continue to write to that computer.

4 ROLLING RESULTS DISPLAY.

A continuously updated RESULTS display can be shown live, in a new window, as scoring proceeds.

A 'ROLLING RESULTS' Window has been added to the READTAGS View Menu. This opens a new re-sizeable window which shows results line by line. It is intended for display on an external video device such as a projector.

See 'ROLLING RESULTS' from the READTAGS Help-- menu for more information. You choose which Courses to display, the number of lines scrolled at a time, the interval between scrolling, and, indirectly, the size of the font. You can show overall results or Category results. The window size is re-sizeable so you can fit it to a projector.

After the results have scrolled through, the information is up-dated from new scored tags, so the display tracks results as they arrive.

If RogaineSCORE.exe is copied into your event folder, (perhaps re-named to RogaineSCORE1.exe), you can run this solely for showing the results.

The original copy of RogaineSCORE can be closed, re-opened, and altered without affecting the rolling results display.

5 PRINTING.

The printing process has gone through a few iterations in recent development. This is the first software release to commence printing the moment a green light shows on the Reader. The data to be printed is passed directly to another thread (another computer core) so it can be done without holding up the main program.

By default, Print threading is enabled. It can be disabled from OPTIONS... in the main Rogainescore window. Even if disabled, Tags are still released while the printing is processed.

In the programming language VB.net, printers are treated as graphics objects like screens, rather than as text devices. This means that each page must be prepared as a picture, which takes time on some printers. Some Fuji-Zerox printers have shown this.

You can measure the time taken to print. In READTAGS, under the TOOLS.. Debug.. menu, click 'Report PRINTING speed'.

After each printing, a 'Printspeed.txt' file is written to your event folder.

It is over-written so only shows the last file printed.

6 SERIAL PORT.

The SERIALPORT driver now supports legacy 9-pin readers, using USB to Serial Port adapters. This means that anyone who still has some of the original Readers can use them again.

7 EDITING A SCORED TAG – INSERTING PUNCHES.

Punch failures are best handled using the traditional “Punch Failure” mechanism from the Re-score extension, where a failed punch can be added to many teams at once. However there are some situations where this doesn’t work.

A typical problem might be someone who failed to use a “FINISH” punch, or someone on a duration-limited course who failed to use a “DEPART” Punch. You can also insert a “BRIEF” punch, although there are existing mechanisms for this.

Open the READTAGS window and the re-score extension. Re-score the tag you want to edit. Its existing score shows in the “Score” window. You select a line by double-clicking it, and it changes colour to Red. You then use the EDIT Menu to “Delete” that punch, or more likely, Insert a punch above the selected line.

If you choose “Insert”, a display of all available punches shows, and you select the punch you want to insert. Then another window opens where you select the time stamp you want to record. This defaults to halfway between the punch above and below.

The Score display shows Inserted and Deleted punches in different colours. When the score looks OK, you must “SAVE” the changes.

The record of editing is stored in the “ScoredTags” folder, as a file called “EditNNNN.txt” where NNNN is the Tag ID. The file is pretty similar to the Rawtags file, but it has “Insert” or “Delete” in front of each punch record. The file is NOT removed if you delete all scored records, or remove Manual editing. It is saved to the network if you are on one, and is saved in the archive.

To cancel the editing, either remove the EDIT file, or re-score the tag and delete all the inserted punches.

8 CREATING A RAWTAG FILE.

If a tag is lost from a team , use the Team scoring –Lost Tag process in Readtags. This is described in Readtags.. HELP.. If a tag fails or is lost.

For multi-tag teams, you use the Lost Tag process to create a Rawtag file, and “Ignore” it’

If there is only this one tag for the team, create the RawTags file. Then you will have to re-score the Tag and “EDIT” it from the Score window, by inserting punches. This is laborious! But it works.

9 FINDING TIME STILL AVAILABLE ON DURATION COURSES.

In duration-limited courses (eg 15 in 24), most teams will return at some stage. They often ask how much time they have left, when they DEPART again.

You can now read one of their Tags. The Score window will show time spent on course as usual, but the scored file is NOT saved if the time of reading is more than 30 minutes since the FINISH punch was used. You can print the Score window if you need a printout.

It is significant that the scored files are not saved. If they were, it causes multiple (and inaccurate) printouts when the final scoring takes place, unless by chance you score this tag first. This is because the scoring process looks at ALL scored tags for the team.

See 'Reading a Tag for time-on-course' in Readtags HELP.

10 OTHER FEATURES.

10.1 The “SETTERS” Course

People who are placing checkpoints often carry a Tag with them, and register each punch as proof of operation and also to bring a record back. Traditionally, reading such a tag produces all kinds of errors because the tag is not assigned to a team or course, and the punch times are all before the Reference time.

Now you can assign a tag to a Course called “Setter”.

You do not need to create a Setter course in your event setup. Open the Tags to Teams window, find your Tag (maybe by reading it), and click in the COURSE box. As usual, all the event courses show in a list-box for you to choose from. At the top of the list is “Setter”. Click on that and save. (You can add your name to the Tag from the NAMES menu.)

When you read a tag, the scoring process recognises the Setter course, and the score display shows the details of each punch and the time of punching. No files are saved. You can print the Score window for a written record, and you can continue to use the same tag without erasing it.

10.2 Partially-scored teams

When PRINT RESULTS is clicked, a search is made for teams where an intermittent punch may have scored on some but not all tags. This is rare but has happened, and some teams are not aware that one of their tags has missed a punch so they do not ask for a “Lost punch” process. Now there is a warning, and the option of correcting the failures.

Withdrawn teams no longer cause a warning when printing results.

10.3 The TAGS to TEAMS window.

Assigning tags by reading them in the TAGS to TEAMS window has been improved to show each person's name and team place, if assigning a tag to each person.

Although the TAGS to TEAMS window is often superfluous if a spreadsheet is used to assign tags, it is still very useful to link a saved text file (from TagTeams.txt) to random tags, if these are assigned at Registration. It also erases the Tags and adds them to Tagnums.txt so is a useful tool for big, multi-tag-set events.

10.4 Spreadsheet.

EventEntriesApril2016.xls and later versions allow saving of Spreadsheet.txt without assigning tags. A newer version, EventEntriesMarch2017.xlsm is undergoing trials.

10.5 Punch labels – allowing more that 10 per decade.

Punch labels can include a single letter before or after the label, for example '54a' or 'b54' are allowed. This means that you are not restricted to only ten punches per decade of points. You can also use higher punch numbers, for example 201, 202, 234, can all have values of 20 points. Be careful with 10 pointers getting mixed with 100 pointers. 100 pointers should be numbered 1000-1099, and 10-pointers 100 -199.

10.6 Tag printouts where there are discrepancies.

Tag printouts for scored teams now prints ALL tags when there are discrepancies, such as different penalties, or missed Punches, or a withdrawn team. Previously only the lowest-scoring tag was printed.

10.7 Messages

Programming a punch without a CP number produces an error warning.

Opening READTAGS performs a sanity check on several files, and reports any potential problems.

11 UI ENHANCEMENTS.

The “Score” display window size and location is saved when you exit the program, and is re-instated when you reload the program. You can revert to the Default location from the main window, from the OPTIONS.. Score Window menu.

The mouse Drag-and-Drop accuracy in EVENT SETUP .. Competitor Classes has been improved.

The HELP... and Score Windows can be printed, either to printer or file.

In READTAGS, 'Tools.. Find unscored teams' adds names and categories to the displayed data.

In READTAGS, the Printer Options button has been moved to the 'Tools...' Menu

The DISPLAY screen has its PRINT tool moved to the main Menu bar.

Presenting a Tag in re-score mode now closes re-score and scores normally.

11.1 Reading BRIEF Punches.

The 'READ PUNCHES' window has improved processing of BRIEF Punches. Previously, they all had to be read before missing teams were shown; they now show as each Punch is read. There is also a Tools.. Menu which allows re-showing the missing teams again, without needing to read a Punch.

Also, the un-briefed Tag display is shown per Course, in start-time order.

12 BUG FIXES.

When creating a new event, the spreadsheet 'EventEntries.xls' should have been copied to your new event folder and re-named. It didn't but now does.

If tags were allowed to score from Tag Start from Readtags Brief menu, Readtags would not load because of a warning message. Now no warning.

The RESULTS window would close after sending results to a real printer.It now remains open to allow other results to be printed.

When reading punches (typically when checking BRIEF punches), there were timestamp errors in the Rawpunch files. Now fixed.

The tutorial in the Basic Reader window malfunctioned. Now fixed.

The 'Erase Tags when read' option in the Readtags window did not function on some Windows 10 64-bit machines. Now fixed.

Assigning tags by reading them did not function if Tagnums.txt was empty, or did not exist. Now fixed.

If tag scoring could not find Course information, a 'Substitute' window opened. You could choose a substitute Course but it didn't work; now fixed.

The 'LOOK FOR ERRORS' routine gave wrong line and team numbers when duplicated names were found in different teams. Fixed.

The 'PROGRAM PUNCHES' window showed incorrect time in Date box, and incorrect date in Time box. Now correct date and time only.

Some versions would close the READTAGS window automatically if there were multiple warning messages. Now fixed.

'Time on course' in printouts is now correct for non-duration limited courses.

12.1 Calibrating Punch clocks.

There is a procedure from calibrating the clocks in the punches, from the PROGRAM PUNCHES window. This is described in the TOOLS.. TOOLS HELP menu.

This procedure has not functioned for a number of years, but an error in the Punch Calibration procedure has been found and fixed. It now works.